

STAGE THIRTEEN • TEAMWORK & COLLABORATION

FIRSTS

DISCUSSION PROMPTS

Open-ended questions to seed group conversation beyond the worksheets

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Discussion Prompts

Stage Thirteen • Teamwork & Collaboration

PURPOSE

Individual worksheets answer “what did your team decide, document, or agree on?” These prompts answer a different question: “what's your real, lived experience of being on a team, good and bad?” They're open-ended and personal, meant to seed conversation beyond a simple share-out of worksheet answers.

Use these during share-out portions, when a session finishes its planned agenda with time to spare, or when a group's energy needs a genuine, specific prompt rather than “any volunteers?” They're organized by session, four prompts each.

As with every stage, these are meant to be read aloud and picked selectively. Many of these prompts invite participants to reference real past teams — be mindful that a negative team experience may still involve real people the participant works or studies alongside; keep specifics about individuals out of the discussion.

Prompts by Session

SESSION 1

Team Foundations

"Has a team you were on ever discovered mid-project that members had genuinely different understandings of the goal? What happened?"

"What's a working norm (response time, meeting style, deadline flexibility) that's caused real friction on a past team when it was never explicitly discussed?"

"Have you ever been part of a plan that was handed to you rather than built with you? How did that affect your actual investment in it?"

"What's held you back from speaking up during a team brainstorm, if anything has?"

SESSION 2

Working Together in Practice

"Have you ever worked on a team where only one person actually kept the shared documentation updated? What happened to it over time?"

"What's the biggest translation gap you've experienced working with someone from a genuinely different function, culture, or background?"

"Has a poorly handled handoff ever caused you real, avoidable extra work? What was missing from it?"

"What's the difference between a team that gives feedback only when something's wrong versus one that does it regularly? Which have you experienced?"

SESSION 3

Navigating Difficulty & Closing Out

"Have you ever helped resolve a team conflict without being the designated leader? What did you do?"

"What's the difference between a genuine team compromise and one side simply being pressured to go along? Have you experienced both?"

"Has a team you were on ever conducted an honest retrospective that covered real failures, not just successes? What made that possible?"

"Looking back across this whole stage, what's one team practice you're genuinely committing to keep using going forward?"